

Lecture 006 – Dissertation and Practical

COMP3050: Individual Dissertation (2025-2026)

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- Welcome back!
- Regular supervision meetings.
- Feedback from supervisors on Interim Reports.
- Ethics:
 - Change in project direction;
 - Procedural issues.

- Requirements and submission procedures for the remaining module deliverables.
- Where to find relevant resources?
- How to get help?

Activity Timeline

Deliverable	Contribution	Due Date
Project Allocation Confirmation	Mandatory	08 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Submit Project Proposal	2%	30 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Preliminary Ethics Form	Mandatory	30 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Full Ethics Form	If required	20 Nov 2025 @ 15:00
Interim Report	8%	16 Dec 2025 @ 15:00
Dissertation	75%	28 Apr 2026 @ 15:00
Demonstration	10%	05 May 2026 @ 15:00
Q&A Session	5%	14 May 2026 @ 11:00 - 13:00

Dissertation

- 75% of overall mark.
- 15,000-word, 40-page limit (a suggested maximum, not a target).
- Code/Artefacts are assessed via the written dissertation.
- Marking rubric available on Moodle.
- The dissertation must be well-written to communicate your project's achievement.



Use of Generative AI

All content submitted in your dissertation must be entirely your own work. The use of generative AI tools to produce any written content included in your dissertation constitutes academic misconduct and will be treated accordingly.

- Ensure proper citation and paraphrasing.
- Use direct quotes where needed and cite sources.
- If uncertain, ask your supervisor for guidance.
- Review the University's [Academic Misconduct Policy](#).

- Late Penalty: University standard (5% per working day).
- Submission Method:
 - Dissertation: Turnitin.
 - Code/Artefacts: Moodle Assignment.
- Format:
 - Dissertation: PDF.
 - Code/Artefacts: ZIP.
- Submission links on Moodle under “Dissertation” tab.

To meet BCS accreditation requirements, must be passed with a minimum mark of 40% and should demonstrate:

- Practical and analytical skills.
- Innovation and creativity.
- Synthesis of information and practices.
- Meeting a real-world need.
- Self-management of a significant piece of work.
- Critical self-evaluation.

- No set structure.
- Sample structure available on Moodle along with previous dissertations.
- Discuss with your supervisor before writing.
- The dissertation should have a clear narrative.

- Use a formal, concise, and precise style.
- Incorporate images, diagrams, and tables.
- Label figures and cross-reference appropriately.
- Recommended resources:
 - *Projects in Computing and Information Systems* – Christian W. Dawson.
 - *On Writing Well* – William Zinsser.
 - *The Elements of Style* – William Strunk Jr.

- Acceptable if work shows progression.
- The marker will evaluate your development since the interim report.
- If unsure, consult your supervisor.

 Ask if your supervisor has a preferred style.

You might find that your supervisor has expectations about the layout and typesetting of your dissertation. It's always a good idea to ask them about this before you start writing. You can do this during your next supervision meeting.

- Keep it simple and consistent.
- Number chapters, sections, figures, examples, and pages.
- Include a Table of Contents.
- Use LaTeX or other typesetting systems where appropriate.

- No set format, but common elements include:
 - Project title.
 - Date.
 - Student name & ID.
 - Supervisor.
 - School & University Logo.
 - Affiliation: *School of Computer Science, University of Nottingham Ningbo China.*
- UNNC Branding.

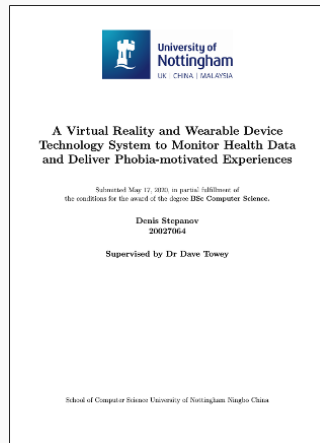


Figure 1: Cover Page Example

- No enforced referencing format, but use a consistent style.
- Again, ask your supervisor for guidance or preferences.
- Use citation tools like BibTeX or Endnote.

- Submit drafts to your supervisor in advance.
- Review examples available on Moodle.
- Your dissertation is unique to your project.
- This is a professional document.
- Document templates are available on Moodle.

Suggested Activity: Rubric Review

- Open the Dissertation marking rubric.
- Review an example dissertation.
- Apply the rubric to assess it.
- Compare Dissertation vs. Interim Report rubrics.

Practical

- Split into two deliverables:
 - 10% – Video Demonstration.
 - 5% – Question & Answer Session.

Demonstration

- 10% of overall mark.
- 10-minute video recording (strict limit).
- Assessment Criteria:
 - Quality of software/practical contribution.
 - Quality of presentation materials.
 - Clarity of communication.
 - Structure and style.
 - Ability to maintain viewer interest.

- Late Penalty: 5% per hour (!).
- Submission Method: Panopto (link on Moodle).
- Format:
 - Video: MP4.
 - Filename: `<student-id>.mp4` (e.g., 2021XXXX.mp4).



Use of Generative AI

Everything in your video recording must be your own work and in your own voice. Using generative AI tools to produce any written, visual or audio content in your demonstration recording is academic misconduct and will be treated accordingly.

- Any images, diagrams, or icons used in your slides or visuals must be properly attributed.
- Any work shown (e.g. code) must be your own, or clearly attributed if drawn from open-source or third-party sources.
- Do not use copyrighted music or audio - use royalty-free alternatives or no audio at all.
- If your demonstration features third-party libraries, datasets, or tools prominently, acknowledge them and include a reference list at the end.
- In general, do not present someone else's work as your own. Use appropriate attribution throughout.

- First attempt won't be perfect – edit recordings.
- Audio & visual quality matter.
- Markers want to see you.
- The recording should tell a story.
- Examples available on Moodle under the Practical Demonstration section.
- Avoid script-reading.

Question & Answer Session

- 10-minute, face-to-face session.
- Invitation via email (sessions cannot be rescheduled unless exceptional circumstances apply).
- Participants: Student, Supervisor, Two Markers.
- No preparation required - just be ready to discuss your project.
- Assessment Criteria:
 - Clarity of answers.
 - Correctness of answers.

FYP Dropbox

FYP Dropbox: An Optional Redundant Submission

- Optional redundant submission for FYP artefacts.
- Provides peace of mind for students.
- Used by staff only if an issue occurs with the main submission.
- You are encouraged to submit all your FYP work here.
- We will not mark from this submission unless there is an issue with the main submission.

- Complete this form only after all deliverables are submitted.
- Prepare the abstract with your supervisor.
- Ensure high quality – consult your supervisor.
- **Final Project Information Form.**

Final Tip: Use the Checklist!
(On Moodle)
